Seriously, Cinderella is So Annoying!

By Trisha Shaskan

STEPMOTHER: You must have heard of me. The wicked stepmother? That's not true. It's just another one of Cinderella's wild stories. Not as wild as the one about the pumpkin, or the one about the fairy godmother. The real story, the true story, began with some chatter- and some dust.

INTRODUCTION

Every story has two sides. It just so happens that we usually hear from the victim's or protagonist's point of view. In the classic retelling of the Cinderella story, the Stepmother has her own opinion of miss goody-two-shoes in. . .

Seriously, Cinderella is So Annoying!: The Story of Cinderella as Told by The Wicked Stepmother by Trisha Shaskan.

STEPMOTHER: All I ever wanted was a husband and a mansion. Before I married Cindy's father, my two darlings and I had met Cindy only a few times. The girl had seemed normal then. After I married Cindy's father, my darlings and I moved in. When I had just one foot on the front step, my dear husband kissed me and said,

HUSBAND: I'm off on business!

CINDY: He's often away, but the animals stay put. They talk. They joke. They sing. They even help out - especially the bluebirds.

STEPMOTHER: Now, I don't mind a good story but I do prefer facts to fiction. Soon, the girl was talking all kinds of nonsense.

CINDY: Once upon a time, one of the bluebirds became blue. Not the color. The feeling. His friend had flown south . . . .

STEPMOTHER: My darlings and I were stuck near the front door. I just wanted to put away my bags. That's when I saw it: dust. *(To Cindy)* Dear, is the whole house this dusty?

CINDY: I don't know. I'll give you a tour!

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STEPMOTHER: In the dining room, Cindy told stories. . . In the study, Cindy told stories. Non-stop. *(To the girls)* Girls, time to get to work. This place needs a good cleaning.

CINDY: Once upon a time when I was cleaning . . .

STEPMOTHER: Oh dear. Cindy mopped the floor. She finished so fast! My darlings had barely started.

CINDY: Did you know robins and sparrows are my friends? The sparrows don't like the robins, though. Silly creatures! Once upon a time, one of the robins . . .

STEPMOTHER: Cindy, dear, why don't you go and wash the clothes now, hmm? *(To audience)* Cindy washed them so fast! How on Earth did she do it? I had to find her another chore, just to keep her busy.

CINDY: If there's one thing squirrels love, it's washing clothes. The rats, though, would rather iron. You know, I . . . "

STEPMOTHER: Squirrels and rats doing laundry? *(To Cindy)* Stop telling such foolish stories!" *(To audience)* Time passed but nothing changed. In the garden, Cindy told stories. In the kitchen, Cindy told stories. At dinner I could hear myself think. *(To Cindy)* Dear please, STOP TALKING! *(To audience)* Cindy didn't stop.

NARRATOR: One day, a letter arrived. It was an invitation to the king's ball. The prince would sure fall in love with one of my darlings. then they would marry, live in a beautiful castle and be the king and queen of the land!

CINDY: Oh Stepmother, I want to go too! Once upon a time a girl and a prince . . .

STEPMOTHER: Then just like that Cindy lost her voice. Imagine! It had to be from all that storytelling. Well, what could I do? I told her she had to stay home for her health. She cried, of course. Still, a ball was no place for a poorly girl. She needed rest. Sometimes it was hard being a stepmother.

NARRATOR: At the ball my darlings twirled, they whirled. Then a strange girl walked in. Her gown was magnificent. I couldn't take my eyes off it. I wondered how much it would cost if my seamstress could copy it for me.

The prince and the girl danced and pranced while my darlings were left prince-less

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A few days later, the prince made an announcement: a glass slipper was left at the castle. The prince would marry the girl whose foot it fitted. Our big chance! After visiting every other mansion in the city, the prince's footman arrived at the door.

STEPSISTER 1: Me! Me!

STEPSISTER 2: NO! Me me.

FOOTMAN: One at a time.

STEPMOTHER: Each girl tried, but the shoe didn't fit. Then Cindy croaked out a whisper. . .

CINDY: P . . . P . . . please let me try.

STEPMOTHER: The shoe fit! Cindy pulled out the other glass shoe from her apron pocket.

STEPSISTERS: WHAAAT!

STEPMOTHER: Cindy croaked again. She said something about a pumpkin and mice that turned into horses. She even added something about a fairy godmother. PLEASE, there is no such thing! I must say, I still don't know where she got those shoes . . . A few days later, the prince married Cindy - the poor man had no idea what he was getting himself into. We, on the other hand, lived happily ever after.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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